Modal Verbs: Modal verbs, also known as modal auxiliary verbs or modals, are a specific group of auxiliary verbs in the English language. They are called "modals" because they modify or add more meaning to the main verb in a sentence. Modal verbs are unique in that they have their own set of meanings and functions that are distinct from regular verbs.

Can: "Can" is frequently used to indicate a person's ability or capability Friendly Permission, Request, Polite Suggestions.

- She **can** play the piano. (ability or capability)
- **Can** I go to the party tonight? (Friendly Permission)
- **Can** you please pass the salt? (Request)
- You **can** try the new Italian restaurant; it's excellent. (Polite Suggestions)

Could: Could" is often used to indicate past ability or capability, Polite Requests and Polite Offers or Invitations.

- When I was younger, I **could** run very fast. (past ability or capability)
- **Could** you please pass me the salt? (Polite Requests)
- **Could** you come to the party tomorrow? (Polite Offers or Invitations.)

May:"May" is often used to ask for or grant permission,Possibility and Probability, Expressing Wishes and Desires

- You **may** use my computer if you need it.(Permission)
- It **may** rain later, so you should bring an umbrella(Possibility and Probability,)
- May your dreams come true(Expressing Wishes and Desires)

Might: Might" is often used to indicate a possibility, but with a sense of Weak probability compared to "may."

- It **might** rain later in the day. (Weak probability)
- She **might** be able to attend the meeting if her schedule allows. (Weak probability)

Must: The modal verb "must" is used in English to express a sense of obligation, compulsion, , Logical certainty, strong advice, Prohibition, necessity.

- You must finish your homework before going out to play. (**obligation)**
- She must see a doctor; her condition is getting worse. (**compulsion/Necessity)**
- The phone is ringing; it must be my sister calling. (**Logical certainty)**
- If you want to succeed in this job, you must work hard. (**strong advice)**
- Students must not use their cell phones during the exam. (**Prohibition)**

Should: The modal verb "should" is used in English to convey advice, suggestions, past advice.

- You should visit the doctor if you're feeling unwell. (advice)
- You should take a break and relax for a while. (suggestions)

  I should have studied harder for the exam. (past advice

Will: "Will" is primarily used to express the future action or make predictions about the future.

- I will go to the store day after tomorrow. (future action)
- I think it will rain tomorrow. (predictions)

Shall: "Shall" is a modal verb in English that is used to express intention.

- I shall attend the meeting tomorrow. (**intention)**
- We shall see you at the event. (**intention)**

Ought to: "Ought to" is a modal verb in English that is used to express moral or social obligation, Strong recommendation.

- You ought to treat others with kindness and respect. (**moral or social obligation)**
- Employees ought to complete their safety training. **(Strong recommendation)**

Have to: "Have to" is a modal-like auxiliary verb in English used to express obligation, duty or responsibility, and External compulsion or unwillingness.

- I have to finish my work by the end of the day. **(obligation)**
- Parents have to take care of their children. (**duty or responsibility)**
- Teachers have to ensure a safe learning environment. (**duty or responsibility)**

- I have to wear a uniform at work. (**External compulsion or unwillingness)**

Would: "Would" is a modal verb in English that serves various functions, expressing Past form of will, offer and request.

- Would you please pass the salt? (**request)**
- I thought you would call me. (**Past form of will)**
- Would you like to have tea or coffee? (**offer)**

Used to: "Used to" is not considered a modal verb in English; rather, it is a modal-like expression used to describe past habits or repeated action in past.

- I used to play the piano when I was a child. (**past habits or repeated action)**
- She used to live in the city, but now she's in the suburbs. (**past habits or repeated action)**

Date to: "Dare" can be used as a modal verb in certain contexts, particularly when expressing courage or lack of courage.

- She doesn't dare to go into the haunted house. **(lack of courage)**
- He wouldn't dare to try that stunt again. **(lack of courage)**

Exercise Last years questions:

What are modal verbs? Give suitable examples.

Insert appropriate modal verb. Meaning is given in brackets:

We……must……..fight for our rights. (Compulsion)

He……should…...stop smoking. (Advice)

They……may……... come anytime. (Possibility)

She……Dare not to…...oppose her husband. (Lack of courage)

Insert Suitable modals:

You……Should….reduce your sugar intake. (Suggestion)

We…must……..obey our elders (Moral duty)

……Would…….you like to join us for dinner. (Polite request)

You……must…...leave smoking. (Necessary)

Insert suitable modal:

……Could……..send me a catalogue please? (Polite request)

This work……might……..more than a week. (A weak possibility)

……Can...I borrow your pen? (Friendly permission)

You……have to……...send this report to head office by tomorrow. (Compulsion)